

Chapter 79-3

Liang Shi subconsciously licked her lips lightly, her tongue tip brushing past the corner of her lips.

Xu Qingzhu's fingers caressed her pulse point again. Her cool, clear voice sounded by her ear, carrying an almost imperceptible alluring undertone. "Teacher Liang, tell me."

Just two simple words, yet they seemed to echo repeatedly in Liang Shi's mind.

Especially the three characters she called out before that—slow and unhurried, the tone rising slightly, yet dropping again at the end. Liang Shi wasn't sure if it was her imagination, but it sounded like she was acting coquettish.

Liang Shi's heart suddenly melted into a complete mess.

The heart that had been tense all evening finally truly relaxed at this moment.

Liang Shi looked at Xu Qingzhu and suddenly smiled. The corners of her mouth lifted, her head tilted back against the sofa, and her body's center of gravity shifted backward, bringing Xu Qingzhu's body back with her.

The two of them fell onto the sofa together, looking like they were snuggling against each other.

Xu Qingzhu naturally let her head rest on Liang Shi's shoulder.

Clearly, Liang Shi's body stiffened, but she didn't say anything.

"Do you really want to hear?" Liang Shi lowered her voice and asked. Her voice carried infinite tenderness and affection.

Xu Qingzhu's fingers closed together, resting on her wrist as if taking her pulse. She responded softly, "Mm."

"Once when I came home, I found three men inside." Liang Shi said. "They had pried open my security window, and they were going through my things. After I saw them, I ran, then called the police. But they weren't caught. I moved afterward and installed three layers of locks. After that incident, I never gave anyone my house keys or passwords. When I'm there, other people can come to my place. But if I'm not there, no one is allowed in."

This story was told in a dry, straightforward manner—not a single adjective, no sense of atmosphere whatsoever.

The way Liang Shi told it, it didn't even feel dangerous.

But the actual situation at the time was that Liang Shi was only seventeen years old and hadn't yet emerged from the pain of losing her closest family member.

A young girl came to the big city to make her way. She finally found a job and rented a basement apartment. It was dark and damp, and in the middle of the night, she could hear mice squeaking inside the wall panels, as if complaining about the poor environment.

That basement had only one window—the sole window that served as the basement's ventilation opening. It was also the only place that ensured this basement could get sunlight during the brightest part of noon.

The installed security window was old and shabby. All it took was a wrench or pliers to open it.

In that prosperous metropolis, there were countless people like her renting basement apartments.

She was just one of the most ordinary among the masses.

Perhaps it was her optimism that kept her from being beaten down by life.

Even during the hardest times, she could still find joy amidst the suffering.

But that day, when she turned the lock and found three burly men standing in her room rummaging through her things, her entire scalp went numb.

Her undergarments were being held in those men's hands, thrown on the ground. The little money she had was fished out from her clothes pockets. The blanket she had folded so neatly was spread out in a mess.

In that space of barely more than ten square meters, everywhere she looked, nothing had been spared.

Those men even let out sinister laughs when they saw her. They weren't afraid at all.

Why would they be afraid?

She was just a powerless young girl.

Fortunately, she reacted fast enough and took off running.

Having trained in sprinting during middle and high school, she burst out with astonishing strength at that moment. She ran all the way outside, out of her old residential compound, and into the police station across the street.

For a period of time after that, it was her nightmare.

Many nights she couldn't sleep because she dreamed about that incident. That's why she never allowed anyone to set foot in her personal territory without her permission.

After first transmigrating here, it had taken her a while to adjust to living with Xu Qingzhu.

But also because she was so busy, with so many things to think about every day, her mild germaphobia hadn't been very severe.

She only gave a brief summary of the incident without going into specific details.

It happened many years ago. There was no need to make Xu Qingzhu worry along with her.

But clearly, what Liang Shi described didn't happen at the Liang family home.

As for where it did happen, Xu Qingzhu didn't ask.

Although she was a bit curious, now wasn't the right time to ask about it.